

SOCIAL AND POLITICAL IDEALS

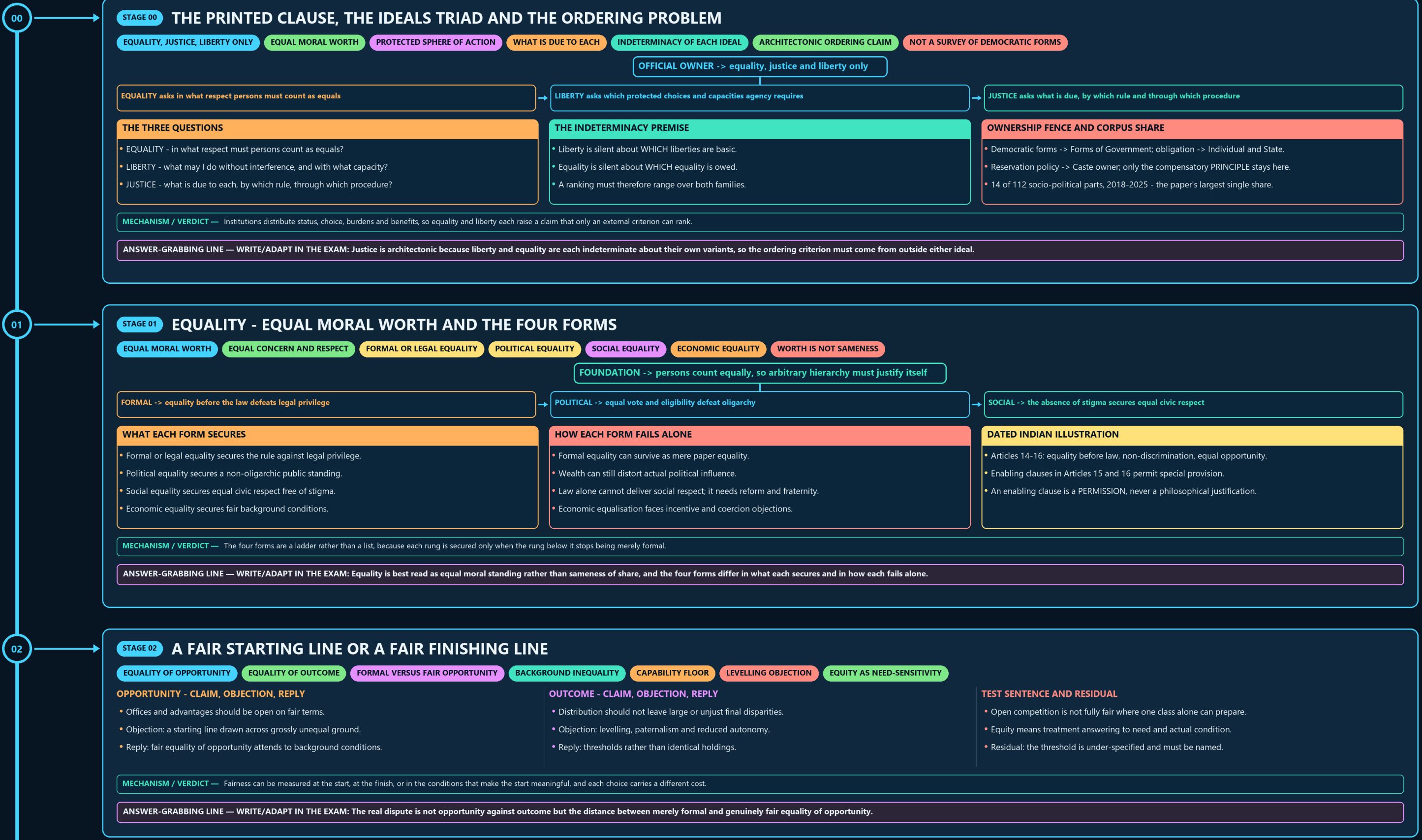
PRINTED CLAUSE AND ORDERING PROBLEM -> EQUALITY: WORTH, FORMS, OPPORTUNITY, EQUITY -> ROUSSEAU, MILL, MARX, AND THE METRIC -> LIBERTY: BERLIN, MILL, THE FOUR ENEMIES, THE THRESHOLD, NON-DOMINATION -> JUSTICE: FORMS, CRITERIA, COMPENSATION, RAWLS, NOZICK, SEN, AMBEDKAR -> THE ORDERING VERDICT

Follow the numbered rail from Stage 00 to the final synthesis at Stage 13. Each card uses the internal grammar its content demands - spatial map, ladder, paired columns, dialectic, process, comparison matrix, timeline and synthesis. The grey E card is optional enrichment and never repairs a gap in the core.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE Pending user review Topic 01 repaired in place and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



03

STAGE 03

ROUSSEAU - NATURAL AGAINST ARTIFICIAL INEQUALITY

EQUALITY OF OPPORTUNITY

EQUALITY OF OUTCOME

FORMAL VERSUS FAIR OPPORTUNITY

BACKGROUND INEQUALITY

CAPABILITY FLOOR

LEVELLING OBJECTION

EQUITY AS NEED-SENSITIVITY

OPPORTUNITY - CLAIM, OBJECTION, REPLY

• Offices and advantages should be open on fair terms.

• Objection: a starting line drawn across grossly unequal ground.

• Reply: fair equality of opportunity attends to background conditions.

MECHANISM / VERDICT —

Fairness can be measured at the start, at the finish, or in the conditions that make the start meaningful, and each choice carries a different cost.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:

The real dispute is not opportunity against outcome but the distance between merely formal and genuinely fair equality of opportunity.

OUTCOME - CLAIM, OBJECTION, REPLY

• Distribution should not leave large or unjust final disparities.

• Objection: levelling, paternalism and reduced autonomy.

• Reply: thresholds rather than identical holdings.

TEST SENTENCE AND RESIDUAL

• Open competition is not fully fair where one class alone can prepare.

• Equity means treatment answering to need and actual condition.

• Residual: the threshold is under-specified and must be named.

04

STAGE 04

MILL - THE SIX SALIENT FEATURES AND THE LIMIT THAT COMPLETES THEM

EQUAL WORTH IN MORAL ACCOUNTING

EQUALITY BEFORE THE LAW

THE SUBJECTION OF WOMEN 1869

INDIVIDUALITY

CUSTOM-MADE HIERARCHY

QUALIFIED ECONOMIC CONCERN

MANUFACTURED NATURE

1 equal worth in moral accounting - nobody is discounted by birth or station

2 equality before the law and equal citizenship

3 women's equality, argued in The Subjection of Women (1869)

4 equality compatible with individuality and self-development

5 hostility to custom-made hierarchy on both utility and justice grounds

6 qualified economic concern - reform, not coercive equalisation

THE GENDER ARGUMENT, EXACTLY

• Subordination is treated as a relic of domination, not a dictate of nature.

• The appealed-to nature is manufactured by the subjection it justifies.

• The evidence is therefore produced by the system under examination.

WHY THE FEATURES HANG TOGETHER

• Excluding half the members wastes capacities and violates utility.

• Removing hierarchy is a means of releasing individuality.

• Equality of status and chance is not uniformity of life plan.

OBJECTION AND BOUNDED VERDICT

• Objection: too individualistic to reach structural economic inequality.

• Reply: within liberalism he extends equality into social relations.

• Verdict: equal status without uniformity.

MECHANISM / VERDICT —

Mill removes hierarchy in order to release individuality, which is why the same doctrine makes him radical on gender and moderate on economic levelling.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:

Mill's equality is equal status without uniformity, and the feature that separates a strong script from an average one is the limit on coercive equalisation.

05

STAGE 05

MARX - EQUITY AGAINST EQUALITY, AND THE RIGHT OF INEQUALITY

FORMAL EQUALITY

EQUITY AS NEED-SENSITIVITY

ABILITY AND NEED

WAGE CONTRACT APPEARS FREE

EQUAL RIGHT AS A RIGHT OF INEQUALITY

HIGHER STAGE, NOT A SALARY RULE

NOT MARXISM AS AN IDEOLOGY

THEME	FORMAL EQUALITY UNDER CAPITALISM	MARXIAN EQUITY
Distribution rule	equivalent exchange among legal equals	distribution by need in higher communism
Hidden reality	class power shapes production and appropriation	production organised for human flourishing
Labour relation	the wage contract appears free and equal	alienation and exploitation are overcome
Moral defect	one rule applied to unequals reproduces domination	unequal needs justify differentiated shares

THE CANONICAL FORMULA

• From each according to his ability, to each according to his need.

• Stated in the Critique of the Gotha Programme.

• Indexed to the higher stage, not offered as a market-time wage rule.

THE ILLUSTRATION AND ITS CORRECTION

• Equal wages for equal hours can still be inequitable with dependants.

• The deeper claim concerns the wage relation, not the scale of pay.

• Equality is a measure; equity answers to condition.

OBJECTION, REPLY AND QUALIFICATION

• Objection: need-based distribution is vague and weakens incentive.

• Reply: the principle addresses a stage beyond scarcity and alienation.

• Qualification: the two-stage structure is a projection, not a proven law.

MECHANISM / VERDICT —

A single common standard abstracts from the very differences that decide whether a share is adequate, which is why equity is the more demanding ideal.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:

For Marx an equal right can be a right of inequality, because one measure applied to unequal need, burden and starting position guarantees unequal effect.

SOCIAL AND POLITICAL IDEALS • TILE 2/5 • same master rows 2699-5933 of 14030 • continues below

Labour relation

Moral defect

the wage contract appears free and equal

one rule applied to unequals reproduces domination

alienation and exploitation are overcome

unequal needs justify differentiated shares

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06

STAGE 06

EQUALITY OF WHAT - SEN, COHEN AND DWORKIN ON THE METRIC

CAPABILITY

CONVERSION OF RESOURCES

ACCESS TO ADVANTAGE

EGALITARIAN ETHOS

EQUALITY OF RESOURCES

BRUTE LUCK AND OPTION LUCK

INDETERMINACY WHERE POLICY ACTS

SEN - CAPABILITY

- The same resources yield different real freedoms across persons.
- Conversion varies with disability, age, gender, climate, health, position.
- Resources are not capabilities; possession is not effective freedom.

COHEN AND DWORKIN

- Cohen: incentives demanded by the talented may be moral bargaining power.
- Cohen: institutional justice can be undone by an anti-egalitarian ethos.
- Dworkin: neutralise brute luck while respecting chosen risk.

OBJECTIONS AND THE INTERIM VERDICT

- Capability lists are indeterminate; Sen prefers public reasoning.
- Luck and choice are hard to separate, yet the line remains clarifying.
- Verdict: equal status, fair opportunity and protection from domination.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Naming the metric converts an approving paragraph about equality into an examinable position that can be defended or attacked.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The modern egalitarian question is not whether to value equality but equality of what, and the answer chosen fixes every later evaluation.

07

STAGE 07

BERLIN - TWO CONCEPTS OF LIBERTY AND THE REAL-SELF DANGER

NEGATIVE LIBERTY

POSITIVE LIBERTY

FREEDOM FROM INTERFERENCE

SELF-MASTERY

REAL SELF AND EMPIRICAL SELF

VALUE PLURALISM

NOT A REJECTION OF SELF-MASTERY

THE TWO QUESTIONS

- Negative: freedom from interference - Hobbes, Locke, Mill.
- Positive: freedom to be one's own master - Rousseau, Kant, Hegel, Green.
- They are different questions, not two quantities of one thing.

THE MECHANISM OF THE DANGER

- Once the person is split, no check remains on who speaks for her.
- Value pluralism explains Berlin's distrust of a single overriding project.
- Enabling conditions are distinguished from forced perfection.

OBJECTION AND THE HONEST VERDICT

- Objection: negative liberty ignores poverty, illiteracy and dependence.
- Reply: the distinction need not deny social preconditions of freedom.
- Berlin identifies a danger in one route, and does not refute the goal.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The split between a real and an empirical self is the step that converts an ideal of self-mastery into a licence for coercion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Berlin's target is not positive liberty as an ideal but the political inference that lets a ruler coerce the empirical self in the name of the real one.

08

STAGE 08

FOUR SPECIFICATIONS OF FREEDOM, SORTED BY THE ENEMY EACH FEARS

FREE WHERE THE LAW IS SILENT

LIBERTY UNDER KNOWN LAW

GENERAL WILL

POSITIVE POWER TO ACT

HARM PRINCIPLE

OFFENCE IS NOT HARM

ENABLING, NOT PERFECTIONIST

THINKER	ENEMY OF FREEDOM	RISK OR OBJECTION
Hobbes	disorder; free where the law is silent	liberty becomes a residual gap left by power
Locke	arbitrary power; freedom under known law	property-centred liberty may mask inequality
Rousseau	dependence on another's private will	the general will invites an authoritarian reading
Green	incapacity; the positive power to act	the state may impose a preferred conception of the good

MILL'S HARM PRINCIPLE

- On Liberty (1859): coercion only to prevent harm to others.
- Self-regarding acts are presumptively immune; other-regarding acts are not.
- Offence or moral disapproval is not harm.

THE BEST DEFENCE OF THE PRINCIPLE

- The doctrine allocates the burden of proof rather than sorting acts cleanly.
- Coercion must show injury, not distaste, and paternalism stays exceptional.
- The instability of the line damages the classification, not the rule.

GREEN'S SAFE READING

- Enabling: enlarge effective capacity and leave the choice of ends alone.
- Education equips agency instead of prescribing a life plan.
- Perfectionism, not enablement, is what attracts Berlin's objection.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each definition of liberty is a remedy tailored to the particular enemy its author fears, which is why the four accounts diverge so sharply.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau and Green differ less about the value of freedom than about its enemy - disorder, arbitrary power, dependence and incapacity.

THE THRESHOLD: TECHNOLOGICAL SOCIETY AND NON-DOMINATION

- Enabling: enlarge effective capacity and leave the choice of ends alone.
- Education equips agency instead of prescribing a life plan.
- Perfectionism, not enablement, is what attracts Berlin's objection.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau and Green differ less about the value of freedom than about its enemy - disorder, arbitrary power, dependence and incapacity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Freedom is better specified as a secured standing than as an event-count, because the un-interfered-with dependant is unfree precisely as a dependant.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A fair-looking procedure operating on an unequal background can satisfy consistency and process while failing the justice of the standard itself.

- Exclusion transmits through wealth, networks, schooling and health.
- Formal equality from today ratifies an unequal starting line.
- It lapses when the targeted transmission no longer operates.

Desert	to each according to effort or sacrifice	honours and recognition
Merit	to each according to competence for a role	offices and appointments
Contribution	to each according to productive value	wages, exchange, titles
Equal share	to each equally	civil and political rights
Compensation	to each according to unjustified loss	rectification of wrong

PLATO AND ARISTOTLE

- Rulers rule, auxiliaries defend, producers provide; reason governs the soul.
- Objection: frozen hierarchy; reply: a norm of competence and harmony.
- Distributive justice is proportional; corrective justice is arithmetic.

MERIT AGAINST DESERT

- Desert is backward-looking and moralised.
- Merit is forward-looking and functional.
- Collapsing them yields the claim that merit is a moral entitlement.

THE COMPENSATORY PRINCIPLE

- Exclusion transmits through wealth, networks, schooling and health.
- Formal equality from today ratifies an unequal starting line.
- It lapses when the targeted transmission no longer operates.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Aristotle's proportional formula is formally correct and materially empty until the relevant criterion for a given good is actually named.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Distributive justice is criterion-plural and sphere-sensitive, and injustice is most precisely defined as a criterion escaping the sphere where it belongs.

12

STAGE 12 **AGGREGATION, RAWLS, NOZICK, SEN AND AMBEDKAR**

AGGREGATION OBJECTION **ORIGINAL POSITION** **LEXICAL PRIORITY** **DIFFERENCE PRINCIPLE** **ENTITLEMENT, NOT PATTERN** **NITI AND NYAYA** **SOCIAL DEMOCRACY AND FRATERNITY**

UTILITARIAN justice maximises aggregate welfare and can sacrifice the few → RAWLS 1971 answers with a fair choice situation and a priority ordering → NOZICK 1974 answers with acquisition, transfer and rectification → SEN moves the question from correct rules to how people actually fare → AMBEDKAR adds that political democracy needs social democracy to survive

RAWLS - THE ORDERING

- Equal basic liberties are lexically prior to the second principle.
- Fair equality of opportunity precedes the difference principle.
- The original position is a device of representation, not a contract.

NOZICK - HISTORY AGAINST PATTERN

- Wilt Chamberlain: voluntary transfers dissolve any preferred pattern.
- The minimal state covers force, theft, fraud and contract only.
- Criticism: unclear starting points and under-specified rectification.

SEN AND AMBEDKAR

- Niti is institutional correctness; nyaya is justice as realised.
- Comparative judgement can rank alternatives without a perfect ideal.
- One vote each can coexist with deep civic humiliation.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each modern theory answers a defect in its predecessor, so the sequence is a chain of corrections rather than a list of separate opinions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rawls does not abolish inequality but civilises it, subjecting it first to equal basic liberties, then to fair opportunity, and only then to the difference principle.

13

STAGE 13 **DEBATES, TRAPS, PREVIOUS-YEAR ANCHORS AND THE ORDERING VERDICT**

AXIS OF DISPUTE **CRITERION OF IMPROVEMENT** **CONDITIONAL VERDICT** **RESIDUAL PROBLEM** **FOURTEEN OWNED PARTS** **NO ONE-SIDED EVALUATION** **ORDERING CRITERION MUST BE EXPLICIT**

NAME the axis of dispute before describing either side → STATE the criterion of adjudication in the opening three lines → WORK one objection and reply fully rather than two half-way → CLOSE with a graded verdict that concedes something to the losing side

THE SIX DEBATES

- Hobbes, Locke and Rousseau; Berlin against Green.
- Rawls against Nozick; Rawls against Sen; Mill against Marx.
- Procedure against substance; Plato's question inherited by Rawls.

THE HIGH-COST TRAPS

- Equality as sameness; Berlin as anti-positive; Mill as licence.
- Rawls with equality first; Nozick as patterned; Sen as economics.
- Justice collapsed into legality or into fair procedure.

THE ANSWER SPINE

- 10 marks: doctrine, spine, one evidence unit and its limit, verdict.
- 15 marks: axis, both sides, one worked objection-reply, conditional verdict.
- 20 marks: thesis, criterion, rival, two residual problems, dated example.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Every question in this clause is an adjudication with a hidden criterion, so the script that names the criterion first has already earned marks.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Liberty and equality are indispensable and jointly insufficient, so any defensible arrangement must make its ordering criterion explicit and publicly defensible.

E

EXTRA **OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - ENRICHMENT ONLY**

RELATIONAL EQUALITY **LUCK EGALITARIANISM** **THIRD CONCEPT OR SPECIFICATION** **PROMOTION LEDGER** **NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER**

OPTIONAL DEBATES

- Equality of what, widened to a full metric dispute.
- Luck egalitarianism against relational equality.
- Non-domination as a third family, or a strengthened negative account.

STATUS AND LIMITS

- Capability and non-domination were promoted into Core on 15 August 2026.
- These residues would move into Core only if a part asked them directly.
- Do not displace Rawls, Nozick, Sen, Mill, Rousseau or Marx with them.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This stage is enrichment for a fifteen or twenty mark answer and is unnecessary for a competent core answer.